Australia, China, India, Japan, New Zealand, republic of Korea, Russian Federation and USA.

Achievements

Unlike the SAARC, the ASEAN has been able to make major breakthroughs in economic and political areas, which have resulted either in major political and economic agreements and accords or pledge to reach such agreements and accords, the major objective being to enforce regional peace and stability, and to maintaining its relations with other countries, regions and organizations.

Some prominent political accords are:

1. *Zone of Peace, Freedom and Neutrality (ZOPFAN):* On 27 November 1971, the foreign ministers of the then five ASEAN members met in Kuala Lumpur and signed the Zone of Peace, Freedom and Neutrality (ZOPFAN) Declaration. It commits all ASEAN members to "exert efforts to secure the recognition of and respect for South East Asia as a Zone of Peace, Freedom and Neutrality, free from any manner of interference by outside powers", and to "make concerted efforts to broaden the areas of cooperation, which would contribute to their strength, solidarity and closer relationship". ZOPFAN recognizes "the right of every state, large or small, to lead its national existence free from outside interference in its internal affairs as this interference will adversely affect its freedom, independence and integrity".

2. *Asean Security Community (ASC)*: To forge political and security cooperation, the ASEAN leaders have agreed to establish the ASEAN Security Community (ASC) with the aim to ensure that countries in the region live at peace with one another and with the world in a just, democratic and harmonious environment. The members of the Community shall pledge to rely exclusively on peaceful processes in the settlement of intra-regional differences and regard their security as fundamentally linked to one another and bound by geographic location, common vision and objectives. It has the following components: political development; shaping and sharing of norms; conflict prevention; conflict resolution; post-conflict peacebuilding; and implementing mechanisms.